

Brand Reputation & Sentiment Monitoring Policy

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APPROVED — ACTIVE

1. Purpose & Scope

This policy establishes the standards for AI-assisted monitoring of customer sentiment, brand perception, and reputation across all public and private channels where TechCorp is discussed. It defines how AI aggregates and analyzes sentiment signals while ensuring that human judgment — not automated scoring — drives brand response decisions and crisis communication.

This policy applies to all Marketing Department personnel involved in brand management, public relations, social media, and customer insights. It also applies to **Customer Support** for service-driven sentiment data and **Legal** for reputation-related legal risk assessment. It operates alongside the **AI Content Governance & Brand Policy (MKT-CONT-001)** for crisis communication content standards.

2. AI Platform Integration

The Marketing Department operates the Enterprise AI Platform's reputation and sentiment monitoring suite, aggregating signals from public and internal sources with coordination across **Customer Support** and **Sales**. Core integrations include:

- Sentiment Aggregation Engine** — AI continuously monitors social media, review sites, news outlets, industry forums, and internal feedback channels (**Customer Support** tickets, NPS surveys, Sales win/loss notes) to produce a composite brand sentiment score with trend analysis and anomaly detection.
- Reputation Risk Detector** — AI identifies emerging reputation threats — viral negative content, organized criticism campaigns, competitor attack narratives, regulatory or legal mentions — and scores them by velocity, reach, and potential impact for PR team triage.
- Competitive Sentiment Benchmarking** — AI tracks competitor brand sentiment using the same methodology, producing relative sentiment positioning reports that provide context for TechCorp's absolute sentiment metrics.

- **Voice of Customer Intelligence Hub** — AI aggregates and themes customer feedback across all channels, identifying emerging product requests, pain points, and satisfaction drivers, with insights routed to **Product** (Engineering) and **Customer Support** for action.

Connected Departments: Customer Support (service sentiment & ticket feedback) • Sales (win/loss & customer health sentiment) • Legal (reputation risk assessment & defamation response) • Engineering/Product (VOC insights & product sentiment) • AI (sentiment model accuracy & bias monitoring) • HR (employer brand sentiment)

3. Permitted AI-Assisted Sentiment Activities

Activity	AI Role	Human Oversight Required
Sentiment monitoring & scoring	Continuous aggregation & composite scoring	Brand analyst reviews weekly sentiment reports; validates AI trend narratives
Reputation threat detection	Velocity & impact scoring of emerging threats	PR manager triages all high-severity threats within 2 hours of detection
Voice of Customer theme extraction	Feedback aggregation & theme clustering	Customer insights manager validates themes; routes to owning departments
Competitive sentiment benchmarking	Comparable metric calculation	Brand strategist reviews competitive positioning quarterly
Campaign sentiment impact analysis	Pre/post sentiment change measurement	Campaign manager reviews sentiment impact as part of campaign reporting
Social listening & trend identification	Volume & sentiment trend detection	Social media manager validates trends; determines response strategy

4. Prohibited Activities

The following are strictly prohibited under this policy:

- **AI auto-response to reputation threats or negative sentiment.** AI detects and alerts. Every public response to a reputation issue, negative press, or viral criticism must be crafted and approved by human PR professionals, with Legal review for significant threats. Automated sentiment-based responses are prohibited.

- **AI-generated public statements during a brand crisis.** Crisis communications must be human-authored. AI may assist with research, background, and draft suggestions, but the final statements must be written and approved by designated crisis communication personnel with Legal review.
- **Suppression or manipulation of negative sentiment data.** Sentiment data, including unfavorable trends and negative feedback themes, must be reported accurately. Suppressing, filtering, or manipulating sentiment reports to present a more favorable picture is prohibited.
- **Targeting individuals based on sentiment analysis for sales or retention pressure.** Sentiment data is a brand health metric, not a sales targeting tool. Using negative sentiment signals to trigger aggressive sales outreach or retention pressure is prohibited.
- **Monitoring competitor sentiment through unauthorized or unethical means.** Competitive sentiment monitoring must use publicly available data and approved third-party sources. Scraping private competitor communities, impersonating customers, or using unauthorized access methods is prohibited.

5. Sentiment Data & Analysis Standards

All sentiment monitoring activities must comply with TechCorp's **AI Safety Guidelines** (AI Department) and the **Marketing Data Governance & Personalization Policy (MKT-DATA-001)**. Methodology requirements include:

- The sentiment scoring methodology is documented and transparent: data sources, weighting factors, sentiment classification criteria, and confidence scoring are published in the Marketing Operations knowledge base and reviewed quarterly.
- AI sentiment analysis must be calibrated for industry context; sarcasm, technical jargon, and industry-specific terminology must be correctly interpreted — the model is tested quarterly against a human-labeled validation set curated by the Brand team.
- Voice of Customer insights extracted by AI are attributed to their source channel and volume; insights shared with Product or Customer Support must include sample size, sentiment distribution, and representative verbatim quotes (anonymized).
- Sentiment data is retained for 3 years for trend analysis; individual social media posts and review content retention follows the data retention schedule maintained by Legal, respecting platform terms of service and data subject rights.

- Multi-language sentiment analysis must be validated by native-speaking reviewers quarterly; automated translation and sentiment scoring of non-English content must meet the same accuracy thresholds as English-language content.

6. Sentiment Analysis Quality Standards

Marketing personnel must adhere to TechCorp's **Prompt Engineering Standards** when configuring AI sentiment tools. Sentiment-specific requirements include:

- Sentiment analysis prompts must include industry context, competitive set, and monitoring period for the AI to produce calibrated, relevant analysis rather than generic sentiment scores.
- Reputation threat detection prompts must include threat categories, severity thresholds, and escalation criteria; vague prompts produce excessive false positives and erode response team effectiveness.
- Voice of Customer theme extraction prompts must specify the feedback sources, time period, and minimum theme frequency to surface meaningful patterns rather than noise.
- All sentiment monitoring prompt templates must be version-controlled, approved by the Brand Manager, and stored in the department's shared prompt library.
- Sentiment model accuracy is benchmarked quarterly against human-labeled samples; accuracy below 85% for sentiment polarity or 80% for threat categorization triggers a model recalibration with the AI Department.

7. Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Chief Marketing Officer (CMO)	Overall brand reputation accountability; crisis communication leadership; final authority on public response to reputation threats; quarterly brand health review with executive leadership.
Brand Manager	Sentiment methodology ownership; brand health metric governance; reputation threat triage oversight; sentiment model calibration; quarterly brand health reporting.
PR & Communications Lead	Reputation threat response leadership; crisis communication strategy and execution; media monitoring and response; public statement approval for reputation incidents.
Social Media Manager	Daily social listening and sentiment monitoring; social media threat detection and escalation; community sentiment trend reporting; response strategy for social-specific issues.
Customer Insights Manager	Voice of Customer program ownership; feedback theme validation and routing; sentiment-to-action insights for Product and Customer Support; NPS and CSAT sentiment integration.
Customer Support	Ticket sentiment data contribution; service-driven sentiment signals; customer feedback collection at interaction points; escalation of service issues driving negative sentiment.
Sales Department	Win/loss reason data for sentiment context; customer health sentiment input; competitive intelligence from field interactions; deal-level sentiment impact awareness.
Legal Department	Reputation threat legal risk assessment; defamation and IP concerns in public content; crisis communication legal review; regulatory implications of public statements.
AI Department	Sentiment model accuracy and bias monitoring; multi-language sentiment validation; threat detection model calibration; sentiment AI prompt standard governance.

8. Incident Response

Any of the following constitutes a reputation or sentiment incident and must be reported within the timeframe specified:

- AI-detected high-severity reputation threat — PR Lead and Brand Manager notified within 30 minutes of AI alert; threat verified within 2 hours; crisis

communication team activated if verified; CMO briefed within 4 hours.

- Viral negative content about TechCorp — Social Media Manager escalates to PR Lead within 1 hour; reach and velocity assessed; response strategy determined within 4 hours; Legal consulted if content includes factual inaccuracies, defamation, or IP concerns.
- Systematic sentiment data failure (corrupted data, model producing invalid scores) — Brand Manager and Marketing Operations notified within 2 hours; affected reporting period flagged; sentiment data excluded from official reports until restored and validated.
- Unauthorized public response to a reputation issue — CMO and PR Lead notified within 30 minutes; response reviewed; if inappropriate, retracted and corrected; root cause of unauthorized publication investigated.
- Sentiment monitoring tool accessing data beyond authorized scope — Legal and Security notified within 2 hours; data collection reviewed; scope corrected; any unauthorized data purged; regulatory implications assessed.

All reputation incidents are logged in the platform's incident management module. Brand crisis incidents activate the crisis communication protocol maintained by PR and Legal. Post-incident review involving Marketing, Legal, and affected departments is mandatory within 10 business days of crisis resolution.

9. Training & Compliance

- All Marketing personnel must complete the Brand Reputation & Sentiment Analysis training within 30 days of hire and annually thereafter.
- PR and social media personnel must complete the AI-Assisted Crisis Detection & Response workshop covering threat triage, escalation procedures, and crisis communication standards.
- Customer insights personnel must complete the Voice of Customer AI & Feedback Analysis certification covering theme extraction validation, insight routing, and source attribution.
- Weekly brand health dashboards are published by the Brand team; monthly sentiment and reputation reviews are conducted with the CMO; quarterly brand health reports are presented to executive leadership.
- Non-compliance with this policy, including suppression of negative sentiment data or unauthorized public response, is subject to progressive discipline administered by HR.

10. Review & Revision

This policy is reviewed every 6 months by the CMO, Brand Manager, and PR & Communications Lead, with input from the Customer Support Department (for service sentiment data and VOC feedback), Sales Department (for win/loss and customer health sentiment), Legal Department (for reputation risk and crisis communication review), AI Department (for sentiment model accuracy and bias monitoring), and HR Department (for employer brand sentiment monitoring). Revisions are versioned, approved by the CMO, and synchronized with updates to the AI Content Governance & Brand Policy, the Marketing Data Governance & Personalization Policy, and the TechCorp AI Safety Guidelines. Emergency revisions triggered by brand crises follow an accelerated 14-day review cycle incorporating crisis lessons learned.

Referenced Policies: AI Content Governance & Brand Policy (MKT-CONT-001) • Marketing Data Governance & Personalization Policy (MKT-DATA-001) • Campaign Performance & Optimization Policy (MKT-CAMP-001) • AI Safety Guidelines (AI Department) • Prompt Engineering Standards (AI Department) • Data Protection Standards (Security Department)